

Ali Raza

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McMaster University | B.CompSc (Honours) | Expected July 2029

EXPERIENCE

Readwise | Application Security Engineer

Sep. 2026 - Present

- Audit web applications for account takeover, authorization weaknesses, sensitive data exposure, and subscription access bypasses.
- Document reproduction steps, security impact, and remediation recommendations; assist developers with fixes and retest patches to verify remediation.
- Joined following repeated vulnerability discoveries and published security research on Readwise.

Ontario Power Generation | Cybersecurity Consultant

May - Aug. 2026

- Identified and resolved multiple vulnerabilities in critical systems.
- Conducted third-party vendor risk assessments, evaluating data classification, access controls, and security posture to identify and document organizational risk.
- Developed a critical-path model of the assessment workflow, mapping task dependencies to establish minimum process completion timelines.

siberX | Developer

Aug. 2022 - Sep. 2025

- Built and deployed a web scraper aggregating **900+ cybersecurity events** from global sources; parsed and structured backend data for frontend use.
- Developed and launched ODTN.News, a cyber-themed news platform supporting cybersecurity conference marketing.

SECURITY RESEARCH

Readwise | Account takeover via CSRF [writeup]

- Used Burp Suite to identify CSRF in the email-change flow and trace an account takeover chain through password recovery. Reported the finding; the vendor acknowledged and fixed it.

8Bitjj | Broken access control, stored XSS & data exposure [writeup]

- Discovered **six vulnerabilities** involving missing API authorization, stored XSS, and excessive data exposure, enabling account takeover, privileged actions, and unauthorized record changes.
- Privately disclosed findings and documented server-side access-control and input-handling recommendations; published after remediation.

ChildsMath | Browser-dependent CSRF protection [writeup]

- Investigated Chrome SameSite cookie behavior and demonstrated unauthorized redirection of academic records. Reported the issue and documented CSRF-token and cookie-hardening recommendations.

Vidar Stealer 3.2 | Reverse engineering & analysis tooling [writeup]

- Reverse engineered encrypted configuration and command-and-control behavior; built **vidar32-toolkit** for offline configuration extraction, artifact scanning, and PCAP summaries.

Terrabot | Log investigation, reverse engineering & YARA [writeup]

- Traced a suspicious request in personal VPS nginx logs to a multi-architecture worm. Analyzed the payload in IDA to document persistence and propagation; published a **YARA rule**, indicators, and detection guidance.

COMPETITIONS

International CyberSecurity Challenge | Canada representative

2026

- Represented Canada in Brisbane in attack-defense and Jeopardy CTFs; analyzed network traffic with custom PCAP tools to identify and mitigate malicious activity, and solved multi-source OSINT challenges.

CyberSci Regionals | 3rd nationally out of 80 university teams

2025

- Placed 2nd in Toronto; solved web exploitation, cryptography, reverse engineering, and forensics challenges under competition time constraints.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security: Burp Suite, API access-control testing, CSRF, XSS, IDA Pro, Ghidra, pwntools

Programming & systems: Python, C, Bash, Linux, Docker

EDUCATION

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